

Meridian — Demo Guide

AI-Powered Logistics Intelligence & Margin Optimization Platform

INTERNAL · SALES ENGINEERING · V1.0

1. What This Demo Is

Meridian is a UI-only sales demo for a unified logistics control tower. It connects drayage, warehouse, dispatch, customer transparency, and margin intelligence — and uses AI to convert every operational signal into a margin decision.

The product story in one sentence: **"One control tower for your entire logistics network — protecting margin on every load."**

The platform demonstrates four jobs:

JOB	WHAT IT DOES
See	Live containers, shipments, dock activity across every facility
Predict	12-week demand and capacity forecasts with confidence bands
Protect	Per-load profitability with AI margin recommendations
Act	Auto-mitigation workflows that turn recommendations into action

2. Why It Matters to the Client

Logistics businesses lose margin in places they cannot see:

- Detention and demurrage from late drayage
- Dock congestion missing outbound SLAs
- Carrier OTP slipping below contract
- Chassis pool fees and accessorial creep on specific lanes
- Negative-margin shipments hidden inside positive-margin lanes

Meridian surfaces these losses, attributes them, and proposes the fix — typically with \$80k–\$140k/month in recoverable margin in a mid-sized operation.

3. Tech & Architecture (Quick)

LAYER	TECH
Frontend	React 18, TypeScript, Vite
Styling	Tailwind CSS with CSS-variable theming (light + dark)
Charts	Recharts
Motion	Framer Motion (subtle micro-interactions)
Icons	Lucide React
Routing	React Router v6
State	React hooks + localStorage for theme/auth/presenter dock
Backend	None — UI-only demo with realistic mock data

The product is designed to sit *across* existing WMS, TMS, ERP, EDI, and visibility systems — not replace them. Integrations page shows 12 connectors (SAP, NetSuite, Manhattan WMS, Blue Yonder TMS, Project44, EDI Gateway, etc.) feeding a unified data layer.

4. Pre-Demo Checklist (15 min before the call)

- ☐ Run `npm run dev` and confirm `http://localhost:5173` loads.
- ☐ Sign in with the pre-filled demo credentials. Confirm you land on Executive Dashboard.
- ☐ Verify the **Presenter Dock** (bottom-left, purple icon) opens and lists 7 scenarios.
- ☐ Verify the **AI Chatbot** (bottom-right, blue gradient pill) opens.
- ☐ Toggle theme (sun/moon icon top-right) once to confirm it works, then leave on light.
- ☐ Open Customer Portal, confirm the customer switcher dropdown works (Halcyon → Crescent → Northwind).
- ☐ Mute Slack, calendar pop-ups, and notifications.
- ☐ Have this guide on a second screen.

5. The 7-Minute Demo Flow

This is the recommended live narrative. The Presenter Dock has these scenarios pre-loaded — you can click through them or follow the script below.

Scene 1 — The Setup (60 seconds) · Executive Dashboard

Click: Sign in (1 click) → lands on Executive Dashboard

Say:

"This is what your VP of Operations sees when she opens her laptop. Top of screen — what the platform is. Below — three signals AI has surfaced as the things worth her attention right now. Each is clickable into context."

Point to:

- Hero pill: "AI-powered logistics intelligence"
- The 4 product tiles (See / Predict / Protect / Act)
- Today's Signals — read the 3 items aloud

Transition: "Let's follow the most expensive one — the free-time risk at LAX."

Scene 2 — Drayage & Free-Time Visibility (75 seconds) · Container Visibility

Click: "Review" on the first signal (or **Containers** in sidebar)

Say:

"1,126 containers in the network. AI ranked these 8 by risk. The MSCU container — top row — is critical: 14 hours of free-time left, \$2,800 demurrage exposure, and the customer is Halcyon, an enterprise account."

Point to:

- Per-row free-time bar (green → amber → red)
- The "Free-time Cluster" alert banner at top
- Click MSCU7349182 row → **drawer opens** with timeline, financials, AI recommendation

Demonstrate:

- "Click 'Apply AI plan'." → toast confirms

Transition: "But this isn't just about a container. It's about what that container is supposed to feed."

Scene 3 — Warehouse + Customer Story (90 seconds) · Customer Portal

Click: Customer Portal (sidebar) — already on Halcyon by default

Say:

"This is the same shipment from the customer's perspective. Halcyon's portal — branded for them, white-labeled. Inbound containers tied to their inventory. Warehouse on-hand at LAX, OAK, SAV. Outbound orders waiting."

Point to:

- Yellow alert banner: "MSCU7349182 projected delay → PO-44245 at risk"
- The 3-column layout: Inbound · On-hand · Outbound
- Note PO-44245 is "Awaiting inbound"

Demonstrate:

- "AI suggests pre-staging 980 units from LAX-01 to cover the cutoff. Click Approve pre-stage." → toast confirms

Bonus (if you have time): Switch the customer dropdown to Crescent Foods. Note how the entire view changes — different inventory, different alert (margin erosion instead of delay), different KPIs.

Transition: "So the customer is protected. But what about the margin on this shipment?"

Scene 4 — Margin Recovery (90 seconds) · Margin Optimization

Click: Margin Optimization (sidebar)

Say:

"Every shipment, customer, lane, and carrier is scored for profitability. The waterfall on the left shows where revenue actually lands. The big number — 18.9% gross margin — is up 2.4 points over plan. But there are leaks."

Point to:

- Margin Waterfall chart — call out detention and rehandle losses
- Negative Margin alert at top: SHP-1021 at -21.4%
- AI Recommendations panel on the right

Demonstrate:

- Pick the "Raise fuel surcharge 4.2% on SAV → ATL" recommendation. Click **Apply** → see the green "Applied" badge replace the buttons.
- "That's \$46,800 a month back in margin. The platform queued the rate change, notified pricing, and updated the lane."

Transition: "These are AI recommendations. Let's see what's running automatically."

Scene 5 — AI Chatbot Moment (60 seconds) · From any page

Click: The "Ask Meridian AI" pill (bottom-right of any screen)

Say:

"Beyond the dashboards, every operator can just ask. Meridian is context-aware across the whole platform."

Demonstrate (try one):

- Click the chip "Which lanes are losing margin?"
- Wait for the typing indicator and the response
- Note the structured meta block (Worst lane / AI recovery / Confidence)

Try a follow-up:

- Type: "How is SAV-07?"
- It returns dock utilization + the rebalance plan

Transition: "And these recommendations don't just sit there — they execute."

Scene 6 — Workflow Automation (45 seconds) · Workflow Automation

Click: Workflow Automation (sidebar — Platform group)

Say:

"8 workflows running today. 1,284 executions in the last 24h. \$81k captured in savings. Each is auditable, governable, and reversible."

Point to:

- "Free-time alert → AI pull plan" — the playbook visualization (Trigger → Filter → AI → Action → Notify)
- Toggle a flow on/off in the table to show governance

Transition: "This is how a single operator can manage what used to take a team."

Scene 7 — The Executive Close (45 seconds) · Multi-Entity Comparison

Click: Multi-Entity Comparison (sidebar)

Say:

"And for leadership of a multi-business operation — three business units, normalized into one view. West is your gold standard at 22.4% margin. East is dragging at 14.8%."

Point to:

- The 3 BU cards
- The radar chart comparing them across 6 dimensions
- The "Playbook Opportunities" cards at the bottom

Closing line:

"Meridian's value isn't just visibility. It's the ability to find the West Coast playbook, replicate it across the East, and protect margin on every load — automatically. That's why customers see \$80k–\$140k/month in recovered margin within the first quarter."

Click: Back to Executive Dashboard → "Generate board pack" → Modal opens → "This goes out to the board every Monday morning."

6. Talking Points by Screen (Reference)

SCREEN	HEADLINE VALUE	NUMBERS TO CALL OUT
Executive Dashboard	"What your VP of Ops sees first"	Revenue \$18.4M MTD · margin 18.9% (+2.4 vs plan) · \$142k AI savings this week
Command Center	"Live operations across every facility"	6 facilities · 87 lanes · 2,418 shipments live
Container Visibility	"Stop demurrage before it happens"	5 at-risk containers · \$14k exposure · \$11k recoverable
Warehouse Intelligence	"Dock congestion, before it hits SLA"	SAV-07 at 88% util · 6 SLAs at risk
Demand Forecasting	"Capacity planning, not capacity firefighting"	173k 12-wk forecast · 92% confidence · 28 scenarios run
Margin Optimization	"Find margin you didn't know was leaking"	\$142k at risk · 4 AI plays · \$116k queued recovery
Dispatch Planning	"AI dispatch every 15 minutes"	8 loads optimized · +\$2,140 savings vs manual · 3 street-turns
Exception Management	"Triage before SLA breach"	12 open · MTTR 2h 14m · 38% AI auto-mitigation rate
Customer Portal	"Higher-end transparency, no extra reporting work"	OTP 94.8% vs 88% industry · branded per customer
Multi-Entity	"Find the playbook, replicate it"	West 22.4% · South 18.6% · East 14.8%
Analytics Workbench	"Ask in plain English, no SQL"	214 queries this week · 1.2s avg query · 182 metrics
Workflow Automation	"Recommendations that execute"	24 active flows · 1,284 runs / 24h · 95.7% success
Integrations	"Sit across what you already have"	12 connectors · 2.4M events / 24h · 182ms latency

7. Anticipated Questions & How to Answer

Q: "Is the data live?"

"This is a UI demo with realistic mock data. The story you're seeing — the container, the customer, the margin recovery — is one consistent scenario across pages. In production it's live, fed by your WMS, TMS, ERP, and event feeds."

Q: "Is the map real?"

"This is a stylized representation. Production uses Mapbox / Google Maps for real geo, with live shipment positions from telematics."

Q: "How does the AI work?"

"Two layers. First, predictive models for demand, ETA, and exception detection — trained on your historical data. Second, an LLM-powered reasoning layer for natural-language queries and recommendation generation, with retrieval over your data warehouse."

Q: "What about our legacy WMS/TMS?"

"Meridian is integration-first, not replacement-first. Look at the Integrations page — SAP, NetSuite, Manhattan, Blue Yonder, EDI, telematics. We sit on top, normalize the events, and add the intelligence layer."

Q: "How fast can we deploy?"

"Pilot in 4–6 weeks for one or two facilities and a handful of integrations. Full network rollout in 90 days."

Q: "Pricing?"

Defer to commercial team — typically per-shipment or per-facility tier-based.

Q: "Security and compliance?"

"SOC 2 Type II, GDPR, CCPA. Audit trails on every workflow. Role-based access for dispatch / warehouse / finance / leadership."

Q: "What happens when AI is wrong?"

"Every recommendation has a confidence score, a preview before apply, and a one-click undo. Workflows are reversible. Nothing happens without an operator-level approval, except for explicitly opted-in auto-mitigations like detention billing or temperature alerts."

8. The Demo Loop (memorize this)

This is the narrative arc to repeat in any order:

Container at port → AI flags free-time risk → Customer impact prevented → Dispatch re-sequenced → Margin protected \$4,000 → Workflow logged → Board sees the recovery

If you remember nothing else, remember those 7 beats.

9. The Three Demo Personas

The same data, three perspectives:

1. **Executive (Ava Rahman, VP Ops)** — Executive Dashboard, Multi-Entity, board pack modal
2. **Operator (Marco Velasquez, Dispatch Lead)** — Command Center, Container Visibility, Dispatch Planning, Exception Management
3. **Customer (Halcyon Retail)** — Customer Portal

When the client asks "who uses this?" — name all three and show how they each see the same shipment differently.

10. Post-Demo Follow-up

Send the client:

- A link to the hosted preview (deploy via Vercel — see Appendix)
 - The Today's Signals card from the dashboard, screenshotted with their company name swapped in if you have time
 - A one-pager with the projected savings from the Margin Optimization page
 - Calendar invite for technical deep-dive within 7 days
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Appendix A — Demo Credentials

URL: http://localhost:5173

Email: ava.rahman@halcyon-retail.com

Password: demo1234

Or click "Continue with Google" — it routes to the same demo session.

Appendix B — Keyboard Shortcuts

SHORTCUT	WHAT IT DOES
⌘ K / Ctrl K	Focus the global search
⌘ ⇧ P / Ctrl Shift P	Toggle the Presenter Dock visibility
Esc	Close any open drawer / modal / popover

Appendix C — Recovery Plan (if something breaks)

1. **App blanks out:** Hard refresh (⌘ R). Session is preserved.
2. **Signed out accidentally:** Email is pre-filled — just click Sign In.
3. **Theme stuck:** Toggle once via top-right sun/moon icon.

4. **Chatbot doesn't respond:** It uses keyword matching. If your question doesn't match a topic, it returns a generic help message. Try one of the chip suggestions.
 5. **Worst case:** Open a fresh tab, navigate to the dashboard, restart the script from Scene 1.
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End of Demo Guide